

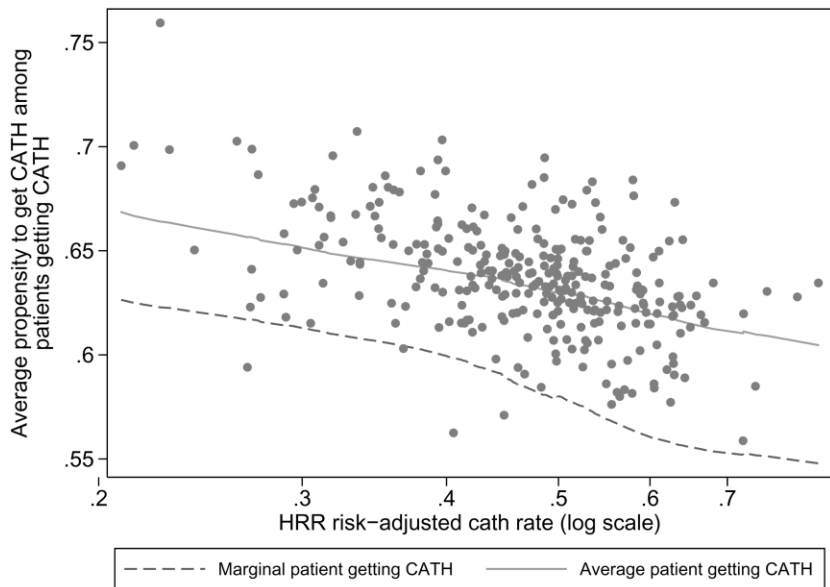


FIG. 3.—Relation between average patient and marginal patient receiving cardiac catheterization. For each of the 306 HRRs we graph the average propensity to receive cardiac catheterization (among patients who actually received it) against the log of the area risk-adjusted cath rate. Using local regression, we estimated the relationship between the average propensity and the risk-adjusted cath rate and the slope of this line at each point. These estimates were then used to plot the average (upper line) and marginal patient (lower line and estimated as the local difference in the average) receiving treatment.